



Initial Post

by **Mariam Ibrahim Ismail Hasan Almarzooqi** - Wednesday, 26 November 2025, 8:48 AM

Hi,

The ACM *Malware Disruption* case highlights major ethical challenges that arise when service providers knowingly enable harmful cyber activity. Rogue Services, the hosting company in the case, allowed ransomware operations, botnets, and large-scale spam to run on its infrastructure while advertising guaranteed uptime (Association for Computing Machinery, 2018). By choosing not to intervene, Rogue violated key ACM principles, including contributing to society (1.1), avoiding harm (1.2), and respecting privacy (2.8).

A central issue in the case is the jurisdiction where Rogue operated. Weak cybercrime laws created an environment where malicious clients could act with minimal consequences, revealing how national regulations struggle to address threats that easily cross borders (Brenner, 2010). When legal action proved ineffective, investigators deployed a specialized worm to disrupt Rogue's malicious infrastructure. While intended to reduce societal harm, this action also destroyed data without user consent, raising privacy and proportionality concerns similar to those described by Aiello (2024).

Rogue's actions caused serious harm including identity theft, financial losses, and reduced trust in online systems. These outcomes conflict not only with the ACM Code but also with the British Computer Society (BCS) Code of Conduct, which emphasizes protecting the public interest and maintaining professional integrity (British Computer Society, 2023).

As Dignum et al. (2018) argue, ethical computing requires more than good intentions; it depends on anticipating consequences and minimizing harm. This case makes clear that global collaboration and consistent ethical standards are essential for addressing cyber threats that span multiple countries.

References:

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Dignum, V. et al. (2018) 'Ethics by design: necessity or curse?', in *Proceedings of the 2018 AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society*. New York: ACM, pp. 60–66.

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